Activity 1:

Aim: To observe the structure of a single cell (Hen's egg).

Materials Needed: A Hen's egg and a plate.

Method: Crack the shell and break open the egg in a plate.

Observation: The egg has a yellow part and a transparent part surrounding it. The white transparent part (albumin) is jelly-like and represents the cell's cytoplasm, while the yellow part (yolk) is thicker and represents the cell's nucleus. On the internal side of the shell can be seen a thin membrane-like structure, which represents the cell membrane.



On the other hand the largest cell is the egg of an ostrich with 170 millimeter width. We can see this with the naked eye.

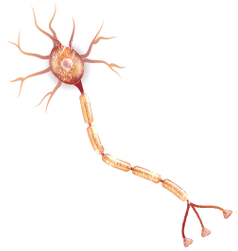
In Human body the nerve cells are believed to be the longest cells.



Cell size has no relation to the size of an organism. It is not necessary that the cells of, say an Elephant be much larger than those of a Mouse.

5.2.2.Shapes

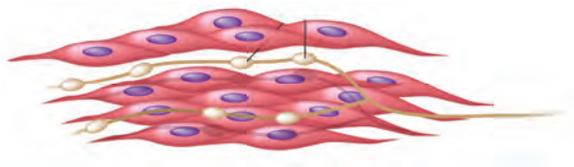
Cells are of different shapes. For example some shapes are given in the below pictures.



Nerve cell



Red Blood cell



Muscle cell

5.2.3.Number

The number of cells present in different organisms may vary. Organisms may be either unicellular (single cell) or multicellular. Organisms such as Bacteria, Amoeba, Chlamydomonas, and Yeast are unicellular.

On the other hand, organisms such as Spirogyra, Mango, and Human beings are multicellular. (i.e) made up of a few hundreds to millions of cells.



Approximate number of cells in the Human body is 3.7 X10^{13} or 37,000,000,000,000.

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